

P.F.O. HOFFSTEINER JR.

37416383

35th AIR DEPOT REPAIR SQ.

A.P.O. 636 70 P.M. NY.



Due 6 cents-L

VIA AIR MAIL

MISS MARTHA LOUISE DARROUGH
~~LUTHERAN HOSPITAL~~

ST. LOUIS, MO, MISSOURI;

5300 Arsenal St

England
June, 10, 1905
Sunday 5 P.M.

Dearest Sweetest,

I have been trying
for a while to get some good words
to start your letter off but I
just could not think of any.
I hope I did a K.

I have a couple very good
reason why I should. First I
have not been writing & you
like I should. But I just could
could not find much to write
about. For they have been keeping
us in camp so long that I am
getting tired & mad at everybody.
You can never see how "tired"
unless you stay in the house
for a week at a time. I have
not even seen a good show. And
last night when I wanted to
go. They did not have any show.
But tonight they have and I

will go to it later.

To-day is Sunday and I woke up with a cold & cold in the head & sore throat. I have been trying to get into work all day long but this thing never goes away. So I spent most of the day in bed, which I do not like to do.

The weather here is bad. It has rained every day for the last 2 weeks. And I would give a lot just to see that rain so that you can not move. And all you do is sit in the room near a sewing machine & drink milk & ice tea.

I hope you do not think I lost my mind but that is just how I feel. I guess when you do get this letter that ice tea idea may not be so bad. But here I could have my overcoat now & perfect.

I have in the last 2 pages told
 you how I feel about getting
 me away. I would like
 you to get the way. Then you
 will see just what your
 very nice letter did for me.
 I could never thank you as
 long as I live. Your letter
 just seen & came when my
 mood is very low. And after
 reading it, I am put it high again.
 just as you did 8 nights. Thanks
 from the bottom of my heart.
 Here was a couple quitted
 told me they would wait to me.
 But since I have left home
 now this 1 1/2 years their letters
 have been almost a least. But
 your has grown. You can tell
 how much you like me by the
 way & the number of letters I get.
 It does not take a man with
 much brains to tell me that you
 most really like & to spend all
 this time & money on me. When

4.

You could have gone out with one
other boy or boys.

I always wanted some girl
I liked as best. And now I think
I found one. She was on Saturday
paper writing to me all that
month. I guess you can tell
by the sound of this letter
that I really miss you. And
it's more so ~~than~~ than any
other day. If I had you here
I could show you how true
that is.

I guess I did enough crying
in your letter for G. & A. But
I just had to get it off my chest.
And since there is not ~~body~~ in
this Army Camp I letter to.
I took you as I know you
would not mind it much.
At least I hope not.
This letter of yours is May 20.
I guess like the way you started
it off with, "Hi Precious," Now put

5.
How precious is that Pigeon in
gold the weight. You would
sure be rich. On second the
thought not so good as the
first; not so good as here
now.

Since you do not go far I'll be
W^m & a Molly. But I'll be the
the ones you like the best. They
got a good clean house. But I
like some of the others ^{as myself} about
I could tell you more about
them when I was here. But now
I only hear a few of them. Don't
forget to see Aunt.

So you put the light work
with 10 and I bet I could beat
you if I had the right kind
of bed. But I bet I can not get
a good sleep in the army bed. Then
5 many a time I thought of
getting in that double bed of
ours. Ray & mine, and never getting
up for two days. Here

6.

all my meals then. That is another
sort was plane plan.

But you are one jump a
head of me. As I never got
your letters in brought to me
while I was in bed. with I
can remember how at Washington
V. You would write me about
breakfast in bed. But you took
the cake with letters in bed.
True I read your letters in bed
but they are not brought
to me.

And what a lunch you
had with Chick's & mine &
apple pie. I just got fresh
back for a supper that
was as good. So my mouth is
watering. But I go down my list.
But I'll be by raising it the
best I never did and much
at home but if I get a chance
I will do it.

this is the last page of this or
 any other paper. So I will
 come & write on the other
 side. I hope you do not mind.
 But if I get some more of this
 type paper. I would have
 you wait until the P.M. if you
 & more. Just then tomorrow
 write you. But that is I long
 & wait & answer this very
 sweet letter of yours. I hope
 you understand now.
 Mother sent me that
 graduation card as I could
 not get one I liked over here.
 The family were like you a
 lot. I am the best. By any
 way I get some your graduation
 there is one thing that we have
 not done and that is learn to play
 the Violin. I never hear
 you play it. I hope you hear
 you when I get back soon.
 Love
 L. J.

You said some thing about
your mother. Does she play if
so what? my dad played
the drums but the rest of our
family did nothing and I mean
this.

There is one thing in your last
couple letters I have had
I have been thinking about.
and that you friends you + I
left at home. You are telling me
in this letter how hard it is
to hold a good connection &
you do not have the same
interest as they do. I just wonder
how Dad will be when, & if
get home. I mean Dad won't be the
way you are in the way & the
other one is the way of fight.
But here on I doing nothing.
I just wonder how it will all
come out.
It is also true of you + me. I
wonder if we will still hold

an interest to each other if we
 ever meet again. You know a
 lot of things & I agree since Oct '73.
 But since I do not have my
 capital call with me I better
 get to a better subject.

One of the officers in the
 1st. Regt. Forgetting to write in
 the nurse copy in England. I
 tell her that is fine & have
 some body you know well over
 here with you. He seems like
 a good f. o. c. but I have not
 talked to him that much.

The reason I said that is because
 every time I think of a nurse I
 think of you and if you were
 here. And do you know how
 many times a nurse are
 something like that is talked about
 today. Well it is a lot.
 Why even a doctor a hospital
 is the same as saying "Mentally
 sound."

10.

Now I charge the subject.
You are you a the doctor coming
along? Is that all it is going
out with the doctor? are
an I so much like the
old ladies over the gate
over the back your fence.

Here is (2) two things in this
dead, dull Sunday and I
made it good. One was your
letter and the other was
you staying or going back
to St. Louis for nine months?
I really like to hear that. You
maybe off before this 9 months
are up they might just
be near St. Louis I hope so.

Say just what are you going
to do at home? and how you
going to stay at the St. Hospital.
I may be a little dumb but
I do not remember you telling

Worrying about that help.
I think I will take a chance
& send this to the Hospital. I
hope I am doing ok.

I am glad to hear you enjoyed
your little St. Louis "more & more"
(that remember reminds me of the
song "more & more.") I hope you
are not just saying that. I
never did go to any other city
more than once twice. So I could
not tell you about any other
city. But I would like to see
Indianapolis.

I think that I will start calling
you Hoosier now. I forgot
all about that before. But since
you are from Indiana. Now
are Hoosier ok.

Does your brother belong to
the P. O. T. C. in his high
school?

12.
So you go for the soft ball
also. Well, I will have to see
you play. I like the idea of
shakes. I hope you did not
get a many scratches. I
can see when your mother
would think you a little old.
But then I bet she would like
could. I have been trying to get
mother to go out for a little ride.
One of these days I will that
or roller skates. See what your
mother says & Dad.

But back to your last soft
ball. The boys I went to are
going to have a game of May 13.
Many when the war is over.
Now as I told you most of them
went to the navy. So the army
team is pretty bad and needs
some good players. So if you
are good enough we

might put you on. But we
 need a good hitting & a fast
 man in the bases. So far I
 can think of about only 4 or 5
 so you see you got a good
 chance. I will write my brother
 & the Navy team & see if we
 can take player (female). If not
 we will have to get those chicks &
 cut you out. If you still come
 tell me. I guess the Navy will
 think we have gone pretty well to
 with a female. But since you
 have a lot of power at the
plate you will be a super.

I can tell you more about
 the private pictures later. They
 do not want us & with so much
 about them.

I have been waiting you
 this letter for the last time.

I hope you do not get tired
 of reading it. I want to tell
 you & I will make them shorter.

But you really helped
 me by telling me whether any
 thing I feel a lot better. I
 also used up all the paper
 I had to, to tell you all about
 every thing.

Well, I want, another letter
 is it it is not. I would like not
 leave you like this if I had
 you in my arms. But since I
 do not have you there I will
 tell you how I miss you &
 wish you were there so I could
 tell you just how much I
 do love you & miss you.
 Love always. Just
 Ray.